TARBIYYAH GLOBAL ACADEMY
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ATTENDANCE, PUNCTUALITY AND CHILDREN MISSING EDUCATION POLICY

Every lesson counts — and every absence is noticed

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026 – 2027

Policy name	Attendance, Punctuality and Children Missing Education Policy 2026–2027
Applies to	All pupils, parents, staff, trustees and volunteers of Tarbiyyah Global Academy
Policy owner	Attendance Lead (Deputy Headteacher)
Approved by	Ustadh Abu Zayn Haneef Sandhar, Headteacher
Agreed with	The Chair of Trustees, Tarbiyyah Education Trust
Date of issue	September 2026
Next review due by	August 2027
Basis	Adapted from the Tarbiyyah Secondary Attendance and Punctuality Policy 2025–26 for online provision
Read alongside	Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy; Live Lesson Protocols; Flexible Learning Policy; Behaviour and Online Conduct Policy; Supporting Pupils with Medical Conditions Policy
Availability	Published on the Academy website and Parent Portal. Available in large print or another accessible format on request.

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1. Purpose

Regular, punctual attendance at live lessons is essential for progress, wellbeing and safety. In an online school, attendance is also our main daily assurance that each child is safe. This policy sets out how attendance is recorded, what we expect of families, and how we respond to absence.

2. Legal and Regulatory Context

The Academy has regard to the DfE guidance *Working together to improve school attendance*, the Education (Pupil Registration) (England) Regulations, Keeping Children Safe in Education, the Children Missing Education guidance and the OEAS standards. Families living outside England should also be aware of any compulsory education requirements in their country of residence.

3. Expectations

Area	Expectation
Attendance target	At least 96% attendance for every pupil
Punctuality	Logged in and ready at the start time of every lesson
Camera	Camera on for registration so the teacher can see the pupil is present and well
Term-time holidays	Not permitted. Leave of absence is granted only in exceptional circumstances by the Headteacher, requested in advance
Flexible Learning	Pupils on an agreed Flexible Learning plan follow the attendance arrangements in that plan

4. Registration

- A register is taken in the first five minutes of every live lesson using Teams attendance and the Student Portal.
- A pupil who joins after registration but within the first ten minutes is marked **late**. After ten minutes, the pupil is marked late for the lesson and the lateness is recorded as a concern.
- A pupil who is logged in but not present (no camera, no response to direct questions) after a reasonable check is recorded as **present but not engaged**, and the form tutor is informed.
- Registers are kept for three years.

5. Reporting Absence

Parents should report absence before 09:00 UK time on the first day, through the Parent Portal's absence form, stating the reason and the expected return. For absence lasting more than one day, parents update the Academy daily.

Code (summary)	Meaning
Present	Attended and engaged
Late	Joined after registration
Authorised absence	Illness, medical appointment that could not be arranged outside lessons, religious observance (for example Eid), or exceptional circumstances approved by the Headteacher

Unauthorised absence	No reason given, or a reason not accepted, including term-time holidays
Technical absence	Unable to connect despite reasonable efforts; recorded separately and reviewed for patterns

The Academy does not routinely require a doctor's note for short illnesses but may ask for evidence where absence is frequent or prolonged.

6. Following Up Absence

1. If no reason has been given, the Academy contacts parents by message and phone by 10:00 UK time (or within one hour of the first missed lesson for pupils on a different time zone pattern).
2. If parents cannot be reached, emergency contacts are tried.
3. If there is still no contact by the end of the day, or there is any welfare concern, the DSL is informed.
4. Where a pupil is absent without explanation for two consecutive days, the DSL considers a welfare call and further action.
5. Where a pupil living in England is absent without explanation for ten consecutive school days, or attendance is irregular, the Academy informs the local authority in line with the Children Missing Education guidance. For pupils abroad, the DSL decides on appropriate action under the Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy.

7. Improving Attendance

Stage	Action
Below 96%	Form tutor discusses attendance with the pupil and parents
Below 92%	Attendance Lead meeting with parents; support plan agreed and reviewed after four weeks
Below 90% (persistent absence)	Formal attendance meeting; consideration of SEND, health, wellbeing or technical barriers; possible Flexible Learning review
Continued concern	Headteacher review; for pupils in England, consideration of local authority involvement; the Academy may review whether the placement remains suitable

Persistent lateness is managed through the Behaviour and Online Conduct Policy and, where connected to the home environment or connectivity, through practical support.

8. Technical Difficulties

Families are responsible for a suitable device and connection (see the Fees Policy). Where a pupil cannot connect, they should: try rejoining once; message the form tutor through the Student Portal; and complete the Teams assignment for the lesson. Repeated technical absence will prompt a conversation about support, which may include a device check.

9. Pupils with Medical or Additional Needs

The Academy works with families of pupils with long-term illness, SEND or disability to agree reasonable adjustments, such as a reduced or flexible timetable for a time-limited period. Attendance awards are

designed so that pupils with a long-term health condition are not disadvantaged; recognition is given for improvement and effort as well as percentages.

10. Removal from Roll

A pupil's name is only removed from the admission register on a ground permitted by the Pupil Registration Regulations, and never until the Academy is satisfied it knows where the pupil will continue their education. Where a pupil living in England leaves at a non-standard time, the Academy notifies the relevant local authority.

11. Monitoring and Review

The Attendance Lead reports attendance weekly to senior leaders and termly to trustees, including patterns by year group, SEND and time zone. This policy is reviewed annually.

Approved by: Ustadh Abu Zayn Haneef Sandhar, Headteacher